

# GREEK VASES

The ancient Greeks used pots, which we call vases, to store grain, wine, oil, and many other things. Some were like bowls and others like cups, jugs, or jars. Vases were made from clay and were often painted with popular myths to entertain their owner or honor a particular god.

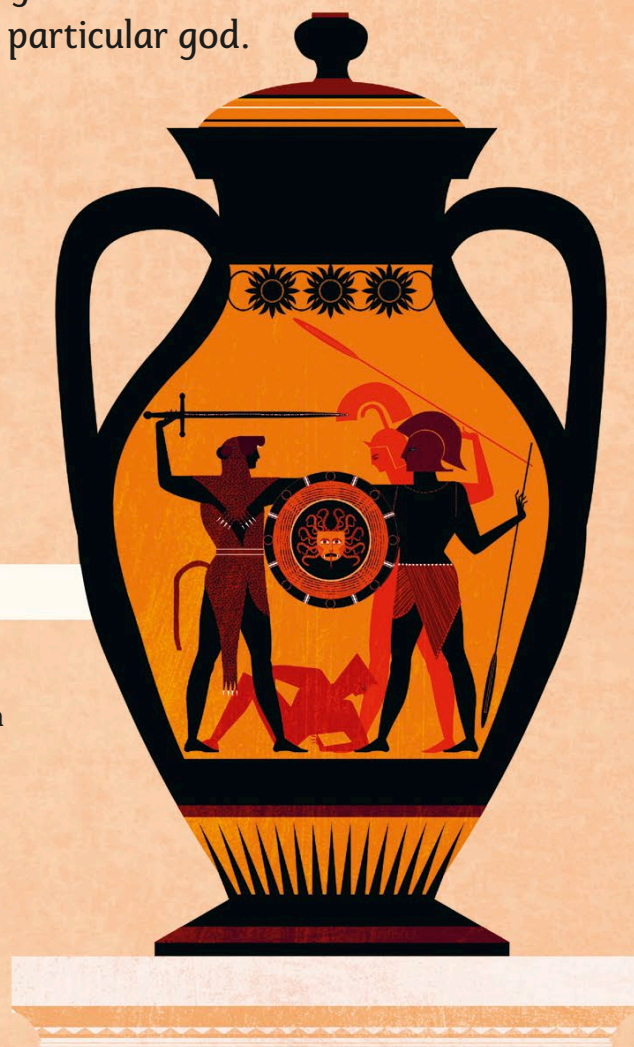
## HERMES

A lekythos was a pitcher used for serving olive oil. This one was painted by an artist known as the Tithonos Painter in 470 BCE. It shows the messenger god, Hermes—recognizable by his winged shoes.



## HERACLES BATTLES GERYON

This amphora from 540 BCE would have been used to store large amounts of grain or oil. It shows Heracles battling the three-headed giant Geryon during his tenth task.



## VASE SHAPES

Ancient Greek vases came in all shapes and sizes. Some had lids and others were open, but they all had a specific purpose in ancient Greek life.



Kylix  
Wine cup

Kantharos  
Wine cup

Aryballos  
Oil jar

Amphora  
Oil, grain, or wine jar